

YEAR 10 (AFTER PREP) · THEME 5 · LIFE IN FUTURE

Reading

B1+/B2

A Postcard from 2126 · Negotiating Tomorrow

Hazırlık Sonrası 10. Sınıf

Name – Surname

Class

No

Date

Aim Understand the main idea and details, make inferences and connect the text to your own life.

1 Before you read

Make predictions before you read.

1. Look at the title. What do you imagine life will be like in 100 years?
2. What is one piece of technology you think will completely change in the future?

A Postcard from 2126

- 1 Imagine a morning a hundred years from now. Your bedroom lights adjust themselves before you even open your eyes, and a gentle voice tells you the weather, your first meeting, and how well you slept. By the time you reach the kitchen, a small robot has already prepared your breakfast according to what your body needs that day. Outside, the streets are quieter than today's, filled with silent electric vehicles and bicycles rather than roaring engines. Most rooftops are covered with solar panels, and vertical gardens climb the sides of buildings, growing vegetables for the neighbourhood. It sounds like science fiction, yet many of these ideas are already being tested in cities around the world.
- 2 Work will probably look very different too. Automation is bound to take over repetitive tasks, from packing boxes to answering simple customer questions, freeing people for more creative or caring jobs. Some researchers predict that by 2126 many adults will have changed careers several times, constantly learning new skills as technology develops. Others are less certain, warning that the transition could increase inequality if only some people gain access to good education and training. Either way, the classroom of the future is set to look nothing like the classroom of today, with lessons designed around each learner's pace rather than a fixed timetable for everyone.
- 3 Not everything, however, is guaranteed to improve. Rising sea levels are likely to force some coastal communities to move inland, and overpopulation in certain regions could put pressure on food, water and housing. Scientists are on the verge of several breakthroughs in renewable energy and medicine, but whether societies use these discoveries wisely remains an open question. Perhaps the most honest postcard from 2126 wouldn't promise a perfect world — just one that is different, and, with the right choices, possibly fairer than our own.

305 words

2 While you read

5 × 2 pts

Circle the correct option.

- What is the main idea of the text?
☐ a Life in 2126 will be identical to life today.
☐ b Future life is likely to bring both exciting improvements and serious challenges.
☐ c Robots will completely replace human workers by 2126.
 - According to the text, rooftops in the future are likely to be covered with _____ panels.
 - According to paragraph 2, what could happen if only some people get access to good education?
☐ a Everyone will benefit equally. ☐ b Inequality could increase. ☐ c Automation will stop completely.
 - According to the text, scientists are completely certain that societies will use future discoveries wisely.
☐ Correct ☐ Incorrect
- _____
- The text says rising sea levels are likely to force some coastal communities to move _____.

3 After you read*Write short answers. Then compare with a partner.*

- Which prediction in the text do you find most believable? Why?

- What is one change you would add to this 'postcard from the future'?

1 Before you read*Make predictions before you read.*

- What do you think a 'vertical farm' might be?

- Have you ever had to negotiate a compromise with someone? What happened?

Negotiating Tomorrow

- Last month, the town council of a small coastal city held an unusual meeting. A group of young engineers had submitted a proposal to turn an old car park into a 'vertical farm' — a multi-storey building that would grow vegetables using solar power and recycled water. Some council members

were immediately in favour, arguing that the project was bound to reduce the town's dependence on imported food. Others were more cautious, worried about the cost and whether local residents would actually support it.

- 2 After two hours of discussion, neither side was ready to give in completely, so they began to negotiate a compromise. The engineers agreed to reduce the size of the project in its first year, while the council agreed to provide a small grant instead of covering the full cost. 'It isn't exactly what we proposed,' admitted one engineer afterwards, 'but it's a realistic first step, and we're likely to expand it later if it works.' The council also promised to review the results in due course, rather than committing to years of funding immediately.
- 3 For many residents watching the debate online, the meeting was a lesson in how future-focused decisions actually get made — not through grand, perfect plans, but through patient back-and-forth negotiation. As one council member put it, 'Nobody got everything they wanted, but nobody walked away empty-handed either. Sooner or later, that's how most good ideas about the future become real.'

238 words

2 While you read

5 × 2 pts

Circle the correct option.

1. What did the engineers originally propose?
Ⓐ Building a shopping centre Ⓑ Turning an old car park into a vertical farm
Ⓒ Closing the town's only food market
2. The engineers agreed to _____ the size of the project in its first year.
3. According to the text, the council and the engineers immediately agreed on every detail of the plan.
☐ Correct ☐ Incorrect
-
4. What did the council agree to do instead of covering the full cost?
Ⓐ Cancel the project Ⓑ Provide a small grant Ⓒ Ask a different company to pay
5. According to the final paragraph, most good ideas about the future become real through patient back-and-forth _____.

3 After you read

Write short answers. Then compare with a partner.

1. Do you think compromise is usually a good way to make decisions about the future? Why or why not?

2. What is one future-focused project you would like to see proposed in your own town or city?
